Cookie Depositor

Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Cookie Depositor / Moulds

What it is used for

A cookie depositor portions and places cookie dough onto trays or moulds in consistent shapes and quantities. Correct hopper loading, nozzle or mould setup, and portion adjustment help maintain product quality and hygienic food handling.

Main parts

- Food-grade dough hopper
- Dosing piston, pump, or portioning mechanism
- Depositing nozzle or mould assembly
- Tray conveyor or tray support
- Control panel and speed or portion controls
- Drive mechanism, guards, and removable food-contact parts

Before you start

1. Confirm the recipe, dough consistency, required portion weight, shape, and production quantity.
2. Verify that the machine is suitable for the dough type and that food-contact surfaces are clean and sanitised according to the food safety procedure.
3. Inspect the hopper, seals, nozzles, moulds, conveyor, guards, and electrical connections for damage or residue.
4. Ensure removable parts are assembled correctly and that seals and fittings are secure.
5. Check that the trays or moulds are clean, dry, correctly positioned, and suitable for the product.
6. Wear clean protective clothing and follow handwashing and allergen-control procedures.

How to use

1. Confirm that the machine is switched off before fitting nozzles, moulds, or other removable parts.
2. Install the required nozzle or mould and verify that it is securely locked in place.
3. Set the portion size, depositing speed, and conveyor settings according to the product specification.
4. Prepare the dough to the specified consistency and load it into the hopper without introducing foreign material.
5. Close the hopper cover and ensure the discharge path is clear before starting.
6. Place trays or moulds in the correct position and check that they align with the depositing outlet.
7. Start the machine using the approved control and produce a small test batch.
8. Inspect the first portions for weight, shape, spacing, and clean release from the nozzle or mould.
9. Adjust approved settings if portions are inconsistent, then repeat the test before full production.

10. Monitor hopper level, portion consistency, conveyor movement, and product accumulation during operation.
11. Stop the machine if a blockage, leak, unusual noise, or unsafe movement occurs.
12. Switch off and isolate power before removing a blockage or reaching into the depositing mechanism.
13. At the end of the run, stop the machine and transfer the product to the next process using hygienic handling practices.
14. Disassemble designated food-contact parts and clean and sanitise them according to the approved procedure.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained personnel should operate or clean the depositor.
- Keep hands away from moving pistons, nozzles, conveyors, and pinch points during operation.
- Never bypass guards or reach into the hopper while the machine is running.
- Switch off and isolate power before clearing blockages, changing moulds, or performing maintenance.
- Use food-safe cleaning chemicals as directed and prevent cleaning residues from contacting ready-to-use product.
- Follow allergen controls and prevent cross-contamination between recipes.

Care & storage

- Clean and sanitise the hopper, nozzles, moulds, seals, and other food-contact parts after use.
- Inspect seals, hoses, fasteners, and dosing components for wear or leakage.
- Check conveyor alignment and portioning accuracy at scheduled intervals.
- Store clean, dry removable parts in a protected hygienic area.
- Arrange servicing if portioning becomes inconsistent, the drive overheats, or product leaks from seals.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using dough with unsuitable consistency for the selected nozzle or mould.
- Failing to clean or sanitise food-contact surfaces correctly.
- Starting production before verifying portion weight and spacing.
- Removing blockages while the machine is energised.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.